

Thomas Nellen

ECONOMIC ADVISOR · SWISS NATIONAL BANK · FINANCIAL STABILITY, OVERSIGHT

Payment economics · financial market infrastructures · money markets and monetary policy
implementation · financial stability

thomas.nellen@snb.ch [RePEc](#) [LinkedIn](#)

September 2026

EXPERIENCE

- since 2011 **Economic Advisor, Swiss National Bank** — Oversight, Financial Stability, Zurich
Leads policy and regulation, covering the revisions of the National Bank Ordinance and the Financial Market Infrastructure Act, the Swiss-UK mutual recognition agreement, and the application of the PFMI to stablecoin arrangements. Deputy CPMI member, member of the CPMI-IOSCO Steering Group and the Policy Standing Group. Systemic importance assessments for LCH, Eurex Clearing, SIX Digital Exchange, Finaity and Libra. Leads four data science proofs of concept on bank liquidity monitoring, settlement liquidity, repo market access and bank stress early warning.
- 2017–2018 **Secondment, Federal Reserve Bank of New York** — Money and Payments Studies, Research Group
- 2006–2010 **Senior Economist, Swiss National Bank** — Oversight, Financial Stability, Bern
Lead overseer of the Swiss central counterparty and central securities depository. Member of the LCH and Eurex international oversight colleges.
- 2002–2005 **Economist, Swiss National Bank** — Financial Market Infrastructures, Zurich
Built the new oversight function. Member of the drafting team for the National Bank Act and the National Bank Ordinance, and of the crisis management steering group with the Ministry of Finance and the Federal Banking Commission.
- 1997–2001 **Junior Economist, Swiss National Bank** — Banking Operations Analysis, Zurich
Established the banking operations analysis function and the bank's active participation in the CPMI.
- 2003, 2005 **World Bank technical assistance missions** — Costa Rica, payment systems; Brazil, securities settlement

EDUCATION

- 2006–2010 **PhD in Economics (Dr. rer. oec.), University of Bern**
Thesis: *Essays in Payment Economics*. Supervisors: Ernst Baltensperger and Antoine Martin.
- 1998–2000 **PhD Programme, Study Center Gerzensee** — microeconomics, macroeconomics, econometrics
- 1992–1997 **Master in Economics (lic. rer. pol.), University of Bern**
Microeconomics and microeconometrics, with mathematics as a minor. Erasmus exchange at the University of Maastricht, 1996–1997.
- ongoing **Advanced methods in data science**
Machine learning, causal machine learning and Bayesian networks. Study Center Gerzensee and GSERM, the Global School in Empirical Research Methods.

REFEREED JOURNAL ARTICLES

- 2021 Monnet, Cyril and Thomas Nellen. The collateral cost of clearing. *Journal of Money, Credit and Banking* 53(5), 939–970.
- 2021 Meuli, Jonas, Thomas Nellen and Thomas Nitschka. Covered bonds, loan growth and bank funding: the Swiss experience since 1932. *International Finance* 24(1), 77–94.
- 2020 Kraenzlin, Sébastien, Christoph Meyer and Thomas Nellen. Covid-19 and regional shifts in Swiss retail payments. *Swiss Journal of Economics and Statistics* 156:14.

2019	Nellen, Thomas. Intraday liquidity facilities, late settlement fee and coordination. <i>Journal of Banking and Finance</i> 106, 124–131.
2019	Guggenheim, Basil, Mario Meichle and Thomas Nellen. Confederation debt management since 1970. <i>Swiss Journal of Economics and Statistics</i> 155:15.
2015	Mägerle, Jürg and Thomas Nellen. Interoperability between central counterparties. <i>Journal of Financial Market Infrastructures</i> 4(2), 49–71.
2015	Kraenzlin, Sébastien and Thomas Nellen. Access policy and money market segmentation. <i>Journal of Monetary Economics</i> 71, 1–12.
2010	Kraenzlin, Sébastien and Thomas Nellen. Daytime is money. <i>Journal of Money, Credit and Banking</i> 42(8), 1689–1702.
2000	Heller, Daniel, Thomas Nellen and Andy Sturm. Swiss Interbank Clearing. <i>Financial Markets and Portfolio Management</i> 14(4).

MONOGRAPHS AND THESIS

2020	Ebner, Till, Thomas Nellen and Jörn Tenhofen. Budget control and payment behavior: evidence from Switzerland. In <i>Cash in the Age of Payment Diversity</i> , International Cash Conference, Deutsche Bundesbank.
2012	Oleschak, Robert and Thomas Nellen. Does SIC need a heart pace maker? In Hellqvist, M. and T. Laine (eds.), <i>Diagnostics for the Financial Markets</i> , Simulator Seminar Proceedings 2009–2011.
2011	Nellen, Thomas. <i>Essays in Payment Economics</i> . PhD thesis, University of Bern.

WORKING PAPERS

2023	Brown, Martin, Yves Nacht, Thomas Nellen and Helmut Stix. Cashless payment and consumer spending. <i>SNB Working Paper</i> 6/2023.
2022	Alexandrova-Kabadjova, B. et al. (20 authors, incl. T. Nellen). Intraday liquidity around the world. <i>BIS Working Paper</i> 1089.
2021	Ebner, Till, Thomas Nellen and Jörn Tenhofen. The rise of digital watchers. <i>SNB Working Paper</i> 1/2021.

Working paper versions of the journal articles above are omitted.

WORK IN PROGRESS

revision	Capel, Manuel and Thomas Nellen. Periods of inactivity and central queuing arrangements.
revision	Capel, Manuel and Thomas Nellen. Payment fragility and central queuing arrangements.
revision	Capel, Manuel, Thomas Nellen and Paolo Vanini. Bank stress event prediction.
revision	Nellen, Thomas, Silvio Schumacher and Flurina Strasser. Settlement liquidity in SIC.
drafting	Brown, Martin, Giannina Elsaid-Miller, Nicole Hentschel and Thomas Nellen. From cash to generation Z: cash usage by the young.
drafting	Fuhrer, Lucas and Thomas Nellen. The relative supply of safety: the spread between treasuries and covered bonds.
drafting	Nellen, Thomas. Factors of resiliency: the Swiss franc repo market during turbulent times.

POLICY PUBLICATIONS

2022	Nellen, Thomas. Stablecoins as new financial market infrastructures? <i>Pay</i> , the payments professional magazine of SIX, 7.
2021	Ebner, Till, Thomas Nellen and Jörn Tenhofen. The rise of digital watchers. <i>SUERF Policy Brief</i> .

2010 Oleschak, Robert, Thomas Nellen und Beatrice Kraus. Simulator bestätigt effiziente Zahlungsabwicklung. *CLEARIT*, Dezember.

INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE REPORTS *selected*

2022 Application of the Principles for Financial Market Infrastructures to stablecoin arrangements. CPMI-IOSCO.

2022 Client clearing: access and portability. CPMI-IOSCO.

2017 Resilience of central counterparties: further guidance on the PFMI. CPMI-IOSCO.

2017 Recovery of financial market infrastructures. CPMI-IOSCO.

2012 Principles for Financial Market Infrastructures. CPMI-IOSCO.

2005 Central bank oversight of payment and settlement systems. CPMI.

Contributor to further CPMI, CPMI-IOSCO and CGFS reports since 2000.

TEACHING

2022 Payments and Central Banks. Central Bank Course on Money and Payments, Study Center Gerzensee.

2012–2018 Money Markets and Financial Stability. Central Bank Course on Financial Stability, Study Center Gerzensee.

2013–2016 An Economic Approach to Financial Regulation. MIME master programme, Universities of Bern and Basel.

1999–2000 Retail Payments and RTGS Payment Systems. Joint Vienna Institute.

PRESENTATIONS AND DISCUSSIONS *selected*

2025 From cash to generation Z. Economics of Payments, Rome. Payment fragility and central queuing arrangements. International Conference on Payments and Securities Settlement, Ottawa.

2024 Payment fragility and central queuing arrangements. Economics of Payments XIII, Vienna. Discussion of Goldstein, Yang and Zeng, Swiss Society for Financial Market Research, Zurich.

2022 Payment networks and bank stress nowcasting. Economics of Payments XI, Bank of Canada, and De Nederlandsche Bank.

2021 The rise of digital watchers. BIS seminar. Discussion of Huynh, Molnár, Shcherbakov and Yu, Economics of Payments X, Bank of Finland.

2018 Settlement liquidity in SIC. Economics of Payments IX, BIS Basel, and Federal Reserve Bank of New York.

2012–2014 The collateral cost of clearing. Bank of England, Federal Reserve Bank of New York, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, University of Basel.

2011 Interoperability between central counterparties. Bank of England, Bank of Canada, BIS, Economics of Payments V, Washington.

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

referee Journal of Money, Credit and Banking; Journal of Banking and Finance; Journal of Macroeconomics; Journal of Financial Market Infrastructures; Computational Economics.

committees Scientific committee, Economics of Payments (2024, 2025); Summer Workshop in Money, Banking, Payments and Finance (2024, 2026); Annual Conference of the International Journal of Central Banking (2026).

2012–2017 SNB editorial committee for scientific publications.